

allow for limits to be set for apps and the device in particular. Parents can even schedule downtimes and whitelist applications which can be used during a scheduled downtime.

Innovation factor = 0/10

Memoji

Memoji lets you build a customised talking avatar. You can change your virtual avatar's skin tone, hair colour, style



and even facial features such as adding freckles. Given the name, it's easy to confuse this with meme-fication of your avatar but that's not the case here. You're making yourself an emoji, hence, me-moji.

Innovation factor = 0/10

Siri Shortcuts

While Siri did start off as the better AI assistant, it lost the crown soon after. The way Amazon and Google have been building up Alexa and Google Assistant, Siri needed something to get back into the race and Shortcuts is a small step in doing that. Macros by another name, Shortcuts aren't a unique addition. Both Alexa and Google have had the feature called Routines which are essentially multiple actions chained together. Siri is now learning to recognise voiceprints, a feature that has been in the works for a while at the competition's R&D facilities. We're hoping that Apple can get it out in the market before the other two.

Innovation factor = 0/10

Group Facetime

If you've used Google Hangouts, then this isn't a new feature at all. Apple's native 1-1 video chat app, i.e. Facetime is now getting the group chat feature allowing for sessions for up to 32 people simultaneously. If that wasn't enough, Group Chat will also support Memoji. Serious meetings can turn into a fun affair at the drop of a hat.

Innovation factor = 0/10

ARKit 2

Perhaps, the only developer related announcement worth a serious mention was the new ARKit 2. Apple is bringing shared AR experiences to iOS so you can have multiple people enjoying the same AR instance. This was demonstrated via the LEGO AR City app where multiple folks could add to the same LEGO construction in real time. Another feature that Apple borrowed from Android is the new Measure app that allows you to measure your surroundings in AR just like what Google's Project Tango did. Now that Project Tango has made way for ARCore, we're excited to see which company will bring more innovative features to the consumer first.

A notable announcement among all the other AR related stuff was the introduction of the new USDZ (Universal Scene Description) format which was developed in partnership with Pixar. Proprietary formats have always impeded the pace of innovation and getting a



universal standard speeds that back up. USDZ will allow more developers to implement AR features since there can be cross-app communication given the universal standard.

Innovation factor = 1/10

Apple Watch Walkie-Talkie

Apple also announced Watch OS 5 bringing a novelty Walkie-Talkie mode that brings 1-1 and 1-many communication. Aside from that, Apple also introduced Gamification features for the health based apps on Watch OS. So you can now challenge your friends and make the experience more interactive and competitive.

Innovation factor = 0/10

macOS Mojave Dark Mode

macOS 10.14 Mojave was also announced at WWDC with a release date set in Fall

2018. Key upgrades include iOS apps such as Apple News, Voice Memos and Home coming to the desktop. A new dark mode that changes the UI colour palette based on time and the depreciation of OpenGL and OpenCL. Apple is pushing for developers to use Metal instead. And there is



no support for Vulkan either. Although, MoltenVK, which allows Vulkan APIs to operate within the Metal framework, is present, its functionality is limited. This will also be the last macOS to support 32-bit applications. The UI darkening is system-wide and not just limited to native macOS apps. The wallpaper if set to one of the dynamic ones will change according to the time of the day. So you will see the sun rise and set over the Mojave desert. Also, the desktop has received some love this time in the form of icon stacking. Files which are of the same format can now be stacked to save space.

Other mentions included native Tracking Prevention to block social media buttons and comment widgets across websites in Safari. Safari will also automatically create, fill and store strong passwords for accounts that you create.

Apple is also introducing new upgrades to its Continuity feature which allows your different Apple devices to work together. Another borrowed feature that's based on Windows Continuum feature. There's also talk about making iOS apps functional on macOS. The new framework that allows this will be made available to developers in 2019.

Innovation factor = 0/10

tvOS 12

Apple TV 4K is getting Dolby Atmos support though it will be restricted to limited content at the beginning. The other feature is that of password-sharing based on FaceID. So if you are logging into a native app such as Photos on tvOS, then tapping on the Passwords will trigger FaceID which will autofill everything.

Innovation factor = 0/10 